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Best Robot Vacuums 2026: Roomba, Shark & Buying Guide

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Introduction

Choosing a robot vacuum in 2026 means juggling suction power, smart navigation, mopping ability, and auto-empty convenience—without overpaying for features you'll never use.

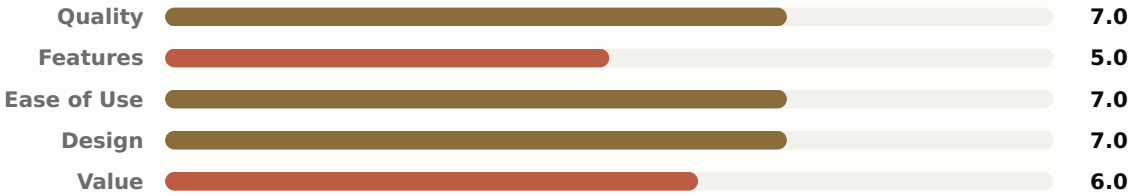
This guide walks you through the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (with and without AutoEmpty Dock) and the Shark AI Ultra / Shark AV2501S AI Ultra, showing exactly how each model fits different homes and budgets so you can decide with confidence.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Why a Robot Vacuum Matters in 2026

Pet hair, dust allergies, and hectic schedules have turned robot vacuums from novelty to necessity. Today's market offers vacuum-only, vacuum-and-mop, and self-emptying bases ranging from under $150 to over $500. Knowing which features matter most helps you avoid paying for capabilities you won't use while still getting a machine that keeps floors clean day after day.

Key Decision Criteria

- **Suction power** – measured in Pascals (Pa); higher numbers pick up embedded dirt.
- **Navigation** – laser SLAM, camera-based vSLAM, or AI obstacle avoidance for efficient routes.
- **Mopping module** – light-wet passes that tackle sticky spills without saturating floors.
- **Auto-empty dock** – transfers debris to a sealed bin, reducing manual emptying.
- **Battery life & smart-home integration** – longer runtimes and voice/app controls add convenience.

(Exact specs are best confirmed on the manufacturers' official pages.)

Model Overview & Pricing (October 5 2026)

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo – with AutoEmpty Dock



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Price: $199.99 View deal

Includes self-emptying base; otherwise identical performance to the dock-less version.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo – Dock-less

Price: $139.99 View deal

Requires manual bin emptying after each run; same suction and navigation as the docked model.

Shark AI Ultra

Price: $249.99 View deal

Features AI-driven obstacle avoidance, strong suction, and optional mopping attachment.

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Price: $239.99 View deal

Similar to the AI Ultra but with a slightly different brush layout and a lower price point.

How to Choose the Right Fit

1. **Identify your floor type** – low-pile carpet & tile favor any of these models; high-pile carpet benefits from the Shark's stronger brush roll.
2. **Decide on mopping needs** – if you only need occasional light-wet passes, the Roomba 115X Combo's mopping module is sufficient; for heavier mopping, consider adding Shark's mopping accessory.
3. **Assess emptying frequency** – large homes or pet-heavy households gain most from an auto-empty dock (Roomba 115X Combo with Dock).
4. **Set your budget** – subtract the cost of features you won't use (e.g., skip the dock if you don't mind manual emptying).
5. **Check smart-home compatibility** – all four models work with Alexa and Google Assistant; verify any required hubs.

By matching these criteria to your lifestyle, you'll avoid overpaying and land a vacuum that truly keeps your floors clean.

Final Recommendation

For most users seeking a balanced mix of performance, convenience, and value, the **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock** at $199.99 offers suction, navigation, mopping, and hands-free emptying in one package. If you prefer to save $60 and don’t mind emptying the bin yourself, the dock-less version at $139.99 is the next best pick. Pet owners who need extra brush-roll power may lean toward the **Shark AV2501S AI Ultra** at $239.99, especially when paired with its mopping accessory.

Whichever model you choose, verify the latest specifications and read recent user reviews before clicking “Buy.”